

RAILWAY TRACK CRACK DETECTION SYSTEM WITH IMAGE SENSING

A MINI PROJECT REPORT

*Submitted to the APJ Abdul Kalam Technological University
in partial fulfillment of requirements for the award of Degree of*

Bachelor of Technology
in
Electronics and Communication Engineering
by

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DECLARATION

I hereby declare that the project report **RAILWAY TRACK CRACK DETECTION SYSTEM WITH IMAGE SENSING**, submitted for partial fulfillment of the requirements for the award of degree of Bachelor of Technology of the APJ Abdul Kalam Technological University, Kerala is a bonafide work done by me under supervision of **Dr. Jeeva K A and Ms. Snehalatha O J.**

This submission represents my ideas in my own words and where ideas or words of others have been included, I have adequately and accurately cited and referenced the original sources.

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CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the report entitled **RAILWAY TRACK CRACK DETECTION SYSTEM WITH IMAGE SENSING** submitted by **SREEHARI M (VAS21EC097)** to the APJ Abdul Kalam Technological University in partial fulfillment of the B.Tech. degree in Electronics and Communication Engineering is a bonafide record of the project work carried out by him under our guidance and supervision. This report in any form has not been submitted to any other University or Institute for any purpose.

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Abstract

The Railway Track Crack Detection System plays a pivotal role in upholding the safety and reliability of railway infrastructure. Leveraging advanced technologies such as ultrasonic sensors and live video streaming, the proposed system aims to detect cracks and anomalies on the track promptly and accurately.

The main function of the system is crack identification, aiding in the decision-making process for maintenance or replacement of tracks. Additionally, the system incorporates Blynk IoT app for real-time alert messages, ensuring timely response to detected cracks, and an IoT platform for data management and analysis.

By enabling continuous monitoring, the system contributes to preventing derailments, reducing maintenance costs, and enhancing overall operational efficiency. Prompt identification of cracks or defects facilitates timely maintenance and repair, thus ensuring the safety and efficiency of railway operations.

Furthermore, the system records live video footage of detected cracks, including their precise locations, providing valuable data for maintenance teams to strategize repair efforts effectively. Overall, the implementation of this system signifies a significant step towards enhancing railway safety and reliability.

Acknowledgement

I take this opportunity to express my deepest sense of gratitude and sincere thanks to everyone who helped me to complete this work successfully. I express my sincere thanks to Dr. S. Swapna Kumar, Head of Department, Electronics and Communication Engineering, Vidya Academy of Science and Technology, Thrissur for providing me with all the necessary facilities and support.

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Contents

Abstract	ii
Acknowledgement	iii
List of Figures	vi
List of Symbols and Abbreviations	vii
1 INTRODUCTION	1
1.1 PREAMBLE	1
1.2 PROJECT BACKGROUND AND MOTIVATION	1
1.3 SUMMARY	3
2 LITERATURE REVIEW	4
3 DESIGN METHODOLOGY	7
3.1 PROPOSED SYSTEM DESIGN	7
3.2 Block Diagram	7
3.3 FLOW CHART	8
3.4 Circuit Diagram	10
4 SYSTEM DEVELOPMENT	12
4.1 HARDWARE	12
4.1.1 NodeMCU	12
4.1.2 ULTRASONIC SENSOR	14
4.1.3 ESP32-CAM	15
4.1.4 NEO-6 GPS module	16

4.1.5	DC MOTOR	17
4.1.6	LITHIUM-ION BATTERY	19
4.2	SOFTWARE	20
4.2.1	Blynk IoT Platform	20
4.2.2	Microcontroller Embedded C Programming	21
5	RESULTS AND DISCUSSION	23
5.1	OVERVIEW	23
5.2	ANALYSIS	23
5.3	RESULT	26
5.4	SUMMARY	27
6	CONCLUSION	28
6.1	OVERVIEW	28
6.2	CONCLUSION	28
6.3	ADVANTAGES	29
6.4	DISADVANTAGES	30
6.5	FUTURE SCOPE	31
6.6	SUMMARY	32
	References	33
7	APPENDIX	35
7.1	CONTENTS	35

List of Figures

1.1	Fact Checking Government claims over Railway track Development .	2
3.1	Block Diagram	8
3.2	Flow chart	9
3.3	Circuit Diagram	10
4.1	NodeMCU	13
4.2	ULTRASONIC SENSOR	14
4.3	ESP32-CAM	15
4.4	NEO-6 GPS module	17
4.5	H-bridge	18
4.6	H-Bridge Driver	19
4.7	Blynk IoT APP	20
5.1	Railway Track Crack Detection System	25
5.2	ESP32 Camera live streaming output	25
5.3	Blynk IoT Location output	26

List of Symbols and Abbreviations

- AI - Artificial Intelligence
- LiDAR - Light Detection and Ranging
- IoT - Internet of Things
- AR - Augmented Reality

Chapter 1

INTRODUCTION

1.1 PREAMBLE

Railway infrastructure stands as the backbone of transportation networks, facilitating the movement of goods and people across vast distances. Central to its functionality and safety is the condition of the tracks themselves. Any defects or cracks in the rails pose significant risks, potentially leading to derailments, accidents, and disruptions in service. Thus, the development of a robust crack detection system is not merely a technological advancement but a crucial imperative for ensuring the safety and reliability of railway operations.

1.2 PROJECT BACKGROUND AND MOTIVATION

The Indian railway system is one of the largest and busiest in the world, covering vast stretches of the country and playing a crucial role in India's transportation infrastructure. Its extensive network spans over 67,000 kilometers, connecting thousands of towns and cities across the country. Managed by the Ministry of Railways, it operates both passenger and freight services, catering to the diverse transportation needs of India's population.

Passenger services are a cornerstone of Indian Railways, offering a wide range of options from local and suburban trains to long-distance express and luxury trains. These services provide various classes of travel, accommodating passengers with

different preferences and budgets. In addition to passenger services, Indian Railways handles a significant volume of freight transportation, moving goods such as coal, minerals, agricultural produce, and industrial products across the country, supporting India's economy and industries.

Railway track maintenance is a critical process for ensuring the safety, reliability, and efficiency of train operations. It encompasses several key activities to keep the tracks in optimal condition. Regular inspections are conducted to identify defects, wear, and potential hazards, utilizing visual inspections, track geometry measurements, and specialized testing techniques. Tamping and ballast maintenance are essential to adjust the ballast for proper alignment, level, and stability, while also cleaning and replenishing it as needed. Rail replacement, welding, and joint maintenance are undertaken to address wear, defects, and failures in the rails and joints, ensuring structural integrity. Additionally, track surfacing and resurfacing are performed to maintain smoothness and evenness, reducing wear on wheels and tracks. Railway track maintenance is a multifaceted and ongoing process vital for the safe and efficient functioning of rail transportation systems[1].As shown in the figure 1.1

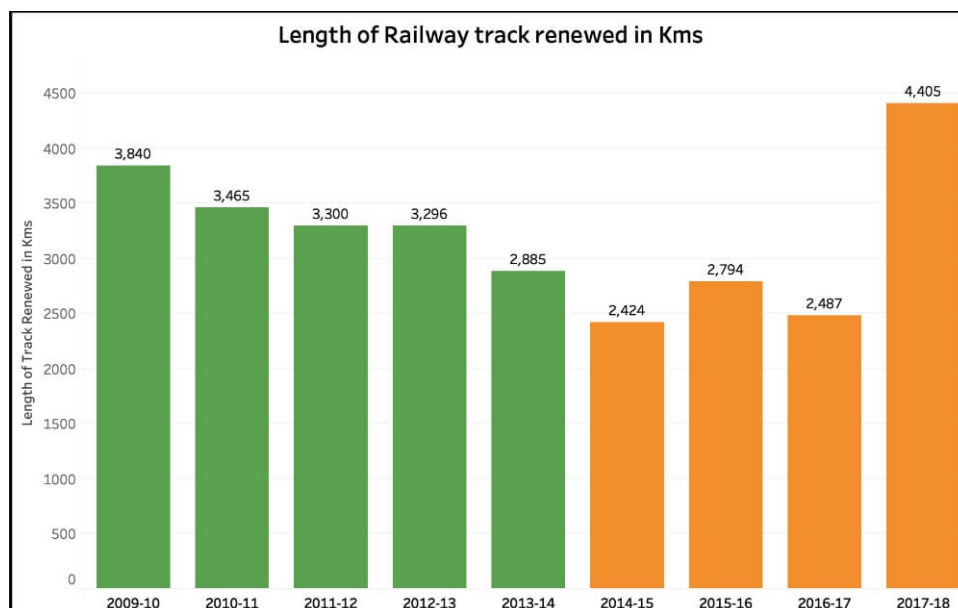


Figure 1.1: Fact Checking Government claims over Railway track Development

1.3 SUMMARY

Railway tracks are a vital component of our transportation infrastructure, and it's crucial to ensure their safety and maintenance. One of the key challenges in maintaining railway tracks is detecting cracks or damages that may compromise their integrity. This is where the railway track crack detection system with image sensing comes into play.

Chapter 2

LITERATURE REVIEW

This chapter deals with the state of art of the literature with respect to the railway track crack detection systems.

- Arun Kumar R, Vanishree K, Shweta K, Nandini C, Shweta G, 2020, Railway Track Crack Detection, In India railways transportation service is the cheap and the majority convenient mode of passenger transport and also for long distance and suburban traffic. The main cause of the accidents happened in railways are railway track crossing and unrevealed crack in railway tracks. Therefore, there is a need to have new technology which will be robust, efficient and stable for both crack detection in railway track as well as object detection. This project discusses a Railway track crack detection using sensors and is a dynamic approach which combines the use of GPS tracking system to send alert messages and the geographical coordinate of location. Arduino microcontrollers used to control and coordinate the activities of this device. As per the study the existing systems are time consuming as well as uneconomical. The proposed system is not only overcome these problems but also improve accuracy and crack detection in rails. It is the most economical solution provided in order to achieve good results of railways of our country in order to minimize the stats of accidents caused. There by possible to save precious lives of passengers and loss of economy. It also saves the time and money for identification of crack[1] .
- N. L. Bhojwani, A. S. Ansari, S. S. Jirge, M. B. Baviskar, D. N. Pawar ,2021, Railway Track Crack Detection System By Using Arduino Microcontroller, The

main objective of the proposed system is to detect the tracks and avoid much accidents. The defect in crack can be found out easily and the preventive measures will be taken immediately. The proposed system not only replace the human inspection but also is beneficial in terms of time and money and makes the inspection very much easier and accurate. Basically, the system operations start with initiating the motor. Initially, the motor starts, which in turn actuates the ultrasonic sensor. Ultrasonic sensor is used to detect the cracks in the track. So, the motor operation is to drive the vehicle forward. Ultrasonic sensor performs its operation scanning and detecting the cracks on the track, when the crack is detected, it will stop the vehicle. Now, GPS will operate getting the coordinates of the location. So, now GSM Module comes into picture which operation is to transmit message to the control room of railway. So, GSM will send a message as "Obstacle Present" as shown in Figure 4 to the pre-determined location. When both the messages are sent and the program will go again on the initial stage and the motor will start again, and it will scan the track[2].

- Pranav Lad, Mansi Pawar, 2016, Evolution Of Railway Track Crack Detection System, 2016 2nd IEEE International Symposium on Robotics and Manufacturing Automation. This system comprises of GPS module, GSM modem, IR sensor, PIR sensor to bring into operation the crack detection, communication purpose and identification of any living being crossing the railway track. The GPS module and GSM modem contribute in identification and transmission of railway geometric parameter of crack detection to the nearby railway station. This paper also explains the summation of an ultrasonic-based non-destructive testing (NDT) and wireless sensor networks (WSNs) to keep in a continuous record the material without interruption in nobility during run-time. The PIR sensor is executed to keep away manual patrolling and finding of living beings across the tracks. This can operate during the night as well as the daytime[3].
- Sanket Salvi, Shashank Shetty, 2020, AI based Solar Powered Railway Track-Crack Detection and Notification System with Chatbot Support, 2019. Third International conference on I-SMAC. There have been several incidents of railway accidents due to derailments caused by cracks in the railway track.

These cracks generally go unnoticed due to irregular maintenance and manual track monitoring. In this work, we have proposed an solar powered autonomous vehicle called “Rail-Rakshak” for inspecting and detecting cracks in the railway line. The proposed robot moves along the path and detects the cracks. The exact location of the cracks is sent to the concerned authorities. The proposed robot leverages the concepts of Cloud Computing and Natural Language Processing (NLP) for better visualization and interaction with the robot. The proposed vehicle detect cracks in its path and is able to identify the location of crack through the GPS Module. The micro-controller is used as a controlling functions to orchestrate communication between sensors, actuators and cloud. The proposed system has to be mobile and hence usage of dedicated on-board rechargeable Li-ion battery is proposed. As the system has to sustain for longer operational time, it has to have capability to harness Solar Energy. The movement of proposed robot is controlled by motor driver connected to the micro-controller. IR sensors are used to detect the obstacle as well as to provide theft alert. Ultrasonic sensors are deployed for detecting distance between track surface and robot, which is used for finding abnormalities in track. Once identified, the proposed robot must halt and communicate to cloud the location co-ordinates obtained by GPS module. Following which the location coordinates are sent in the form of telegram message to the predefined mobile number using the on-board GSM Module. The Cloud platform is used to communicate all the sensor data and GPS coordinates to the Chat Bot[4].

Chapter 3

DESIGN METHODOLOGY

3.1 PROPOSED SYSTEM DESIGN

The proposed system integrates advanced technologies like ultrasonic sensors and live video streaming to enhance railway track monitoring. Ultrasonic sensors continuously scan for abnormalities, detecting even minute cracks or defects, while video cameras provide real-time visual confirmation. This continuous monitoring enables timely detection of issues, preventing derailments and reducing maintenance costs.

By facilitating proactive maintenance, the system improves overall operational efficiency, minimizing disruptions and optimizing resource allocation. Timely identification of track anomalies allows for prompt repairs, ensuring the safety and integrity of railway operations. Moreover, the system records live video of detected anomalies, aiding maintenance teams in analyzing track conditions and planning future maintenance activities.

3.2 Block Diagram

The proposed system block diagram is shown in fig:3.1, In railway track crack detection system the integration of NodeMCU, ultrasonic sensor, ESP32-CAM, NEO-6 GPS module, DC motor, and lithium-ion battery ensures comprehensive monitoring and timely maintenance. The ultrasonic sensor, mounted on a moving platform, detects track anomalies by analyzing reflections of emitted waves. Meanwhile, the

ESP32-CAM provides live video streaming, offering visual confirmation of detected irregularities.

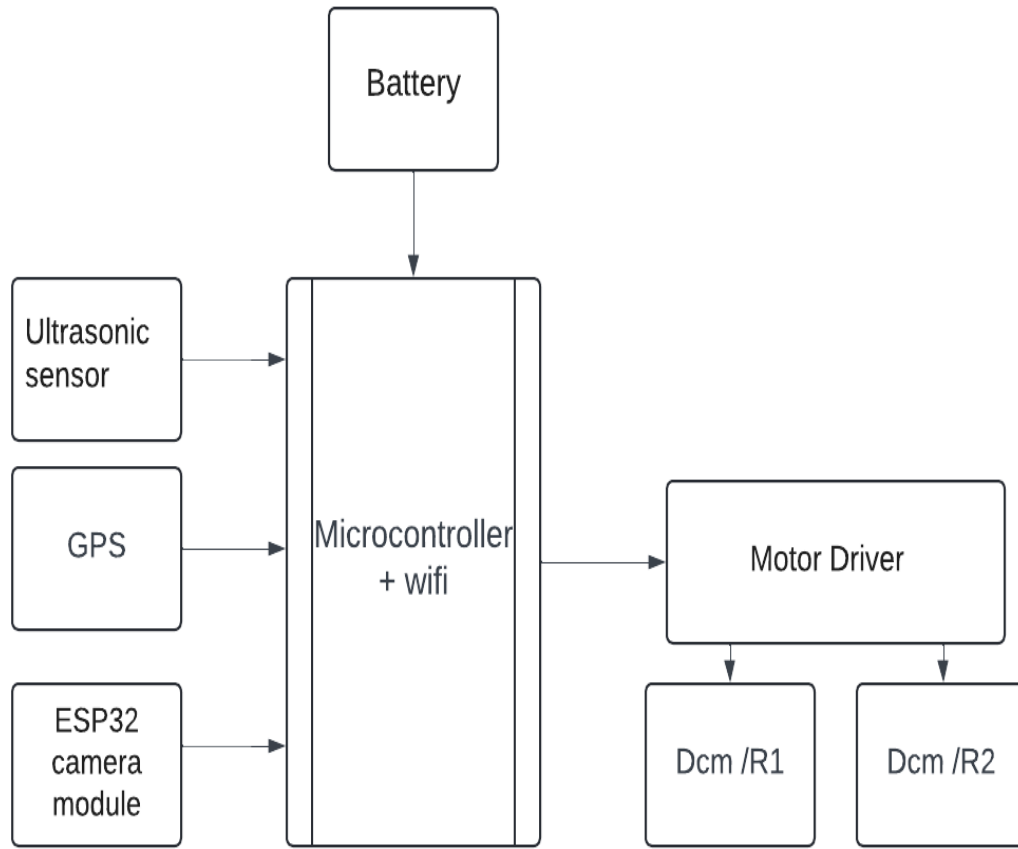


Figure 3.1: Block Diagram

The NEO-6 GPS module accurately geotags anomalies, facilitating precise location identification. Powered by the lithium-ion battery, the DC motor propels the system along the track, enabling thorough coverage. The NodeMCU serves as the central processor, coordinating the functions of the components and executing predefined algorithms. Together, these components enable continuous track monitoring, proactive maintenance, and efficient operation, enhancing railway safety and reliability[1].

3.3 FLOW CHART

The operational flow begins with the initialization of all components, including the NodeMCU, ultrasonic sensor, ESP32-CAM, NEO-6 GPS module, DC motor.

Subsequently, the DC motor is activated to propel the system along the railway track, facilitating data collection from various sensors. The ultrasonic sensor emits waves towards the track, receiving and analyzing reflected waves for anomalies, while the ESP32-CAM captures live video footage for visual confirmation. Figure:3.2 shows the flow chart for the proposed system.

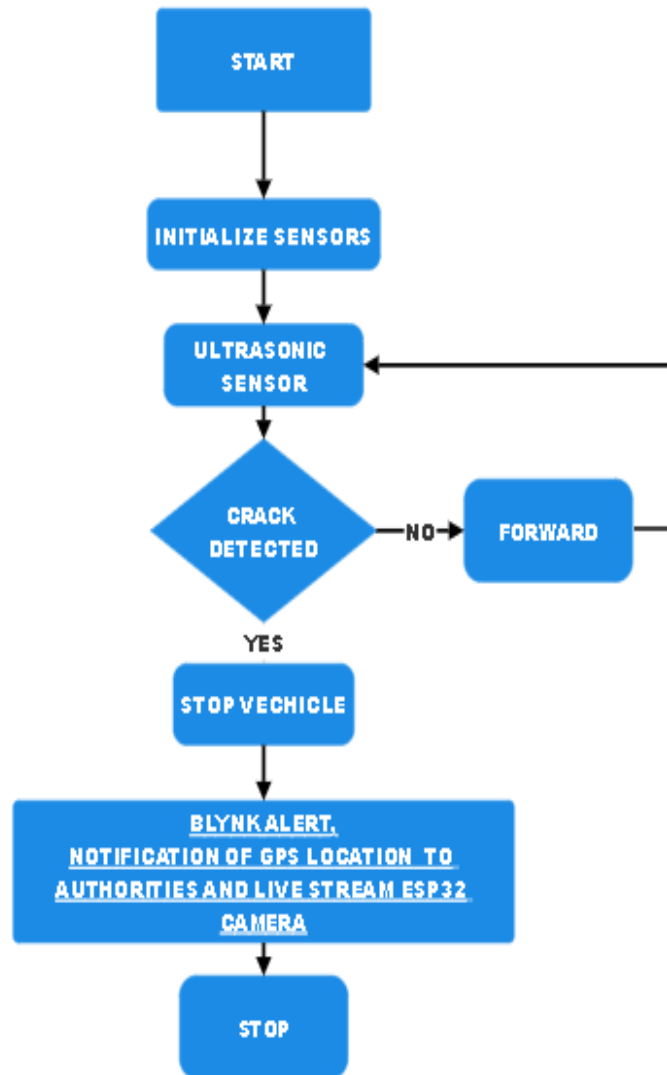


Figure 3.2: Flow chart

Simultaneously, the NEO-6 GPS module retrieves precise location data and geotags anomalies for accurate identification. The NodeMCU serves as the central processor, receiving and processing data from sensors and cameras, executing predefined

algorithms to detect cracks or defects. Detected anomalies' severity and location are determined, and relevant data, including timestamp and GPS coordinates, are stored. In the event of a significant anomaly, a maintenance alert is triggered, notifying relevant authorities and providing real-time data for immediate action.

3.4 Circuit Diagram

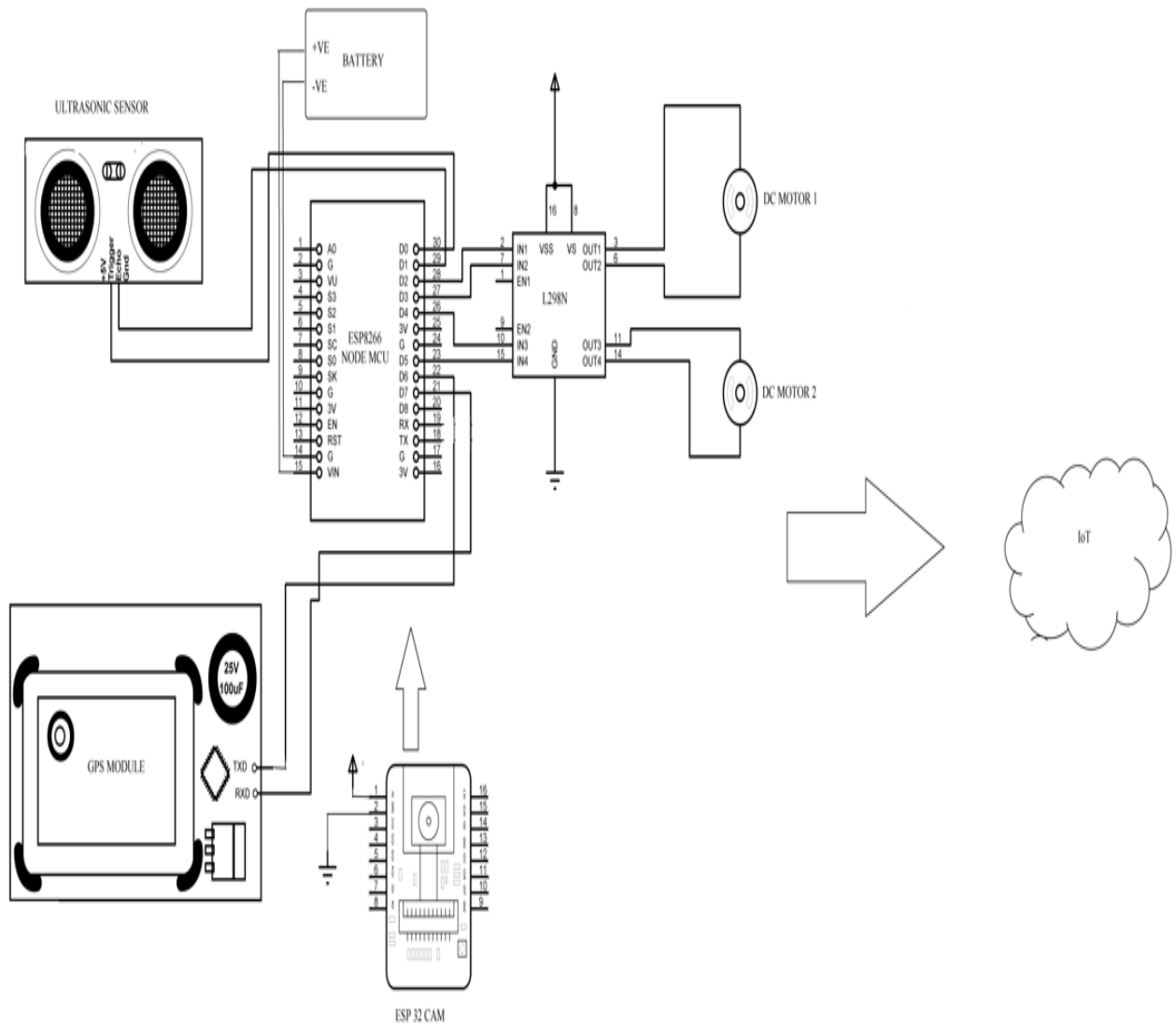


Figure 3.3: Circuit Diagram

Figure:3.3 shows the circuit diagram of the proposed system. NodeMCU is used as controller unit. The DC motor is activated to propel the system along the railway track,

facilitating data collection from various sensors. The ultrasonic sensor emits waves towards the track, receiving and analyzing reflected waves for anomalies, while the ESP32-CAM captures live video footage for visual confirmation. Simultaneously, the NEO-6 GPS module retrieves precise location data and geotags anomalies for accurate identification.

The NodeMCU serves as the central processor, receiving and processing data from sensors and cameras, executing predefined algorithms to detect cracks or defects. Detected anomalies' severity and location are determined, and relevant data, including timestamp and GPS coordinates, are stored. In the event of a significant anomaly, a maintenance alert is triggered, notifying relevant authorities and providing real-time data for immediate action. Additionally, the system may be integrated with an IoT platform to enable remote monitoring and management, facilitating proactive maintenance and enhancing overall efficiency.

Chapter 4

SYSTEM DEVELOPMENT

The project involves the development of a comprehensive system for crack detection and monitoring, combining both software and hardware components. Software development was carried out using the C programming language, known for its efficiency and low-level hardware access, to create firmware or low-level software for controlling the system. On the hardware side, an ultrasonic sensor was employed for crack detection, utilizing its ability to emit high-frequency sound waves and measure their reflection time to identify cracks or obstacles.

4.1 HARDWARE

4.1.1 NodeMCU

The NodeMCU (Node MicroController Unit) is an open-source software and hardware development environment built around an inexpensive System-on-a-Chip (SoC) called the ESP8266. The ESP8266, designed and manufactured by Espressif Systems, contains the crucial elements of a computer: CPU, RAM, networking (WiFi), and even a modern operating system and SDK. That makes it an excellent choice for Internet of Things (IoT) projects of all kinds.

The ESP8266 uses a 32bit processor with 16 bit instructions. It is Harvard architecture which mostly means that instruction memory and data memory are completely separate. The ESP8266 has on die program Read-Only Memory (ROM) which includes some library code and a first stage boot loader. All the rest of the

code must be stored in external Serial flash memory (provides only serial access to the data - rather than addressing individual bytes, the user reads or writes large contiguous groups of bytes in the address space serially)[1].Figure 4.1 shows NodeMCU

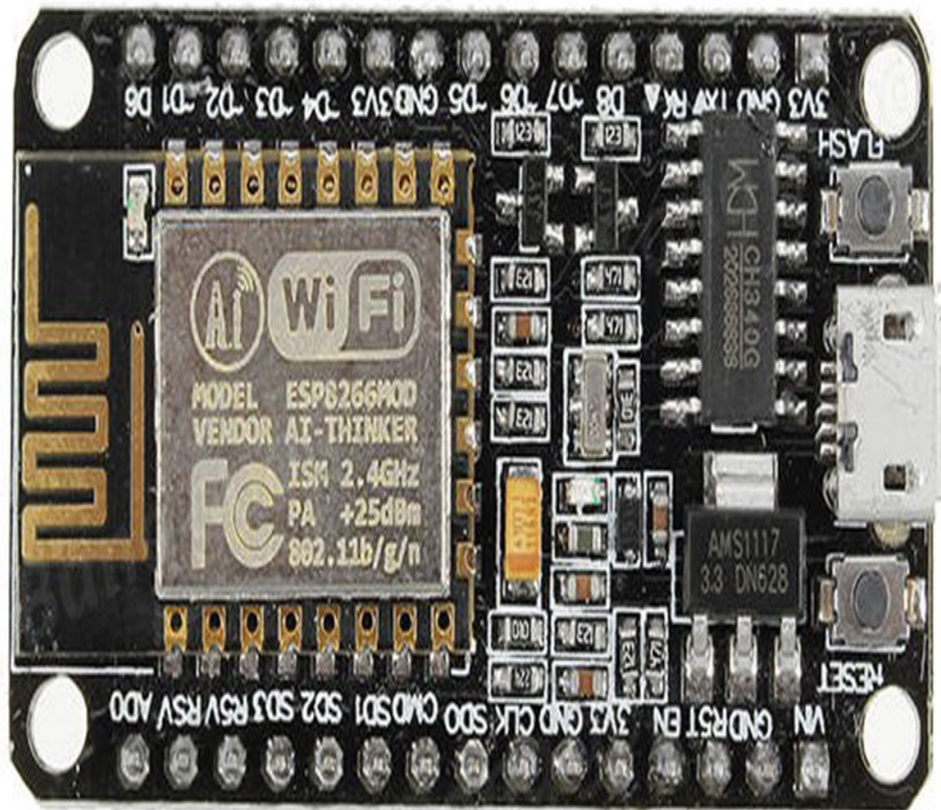


Figure 4.1: NodeMCU

ESP8266 has 17 GPIO pins but only 11 can be used (among 17 pins, 6 are used for communication with the on-board flash memory chip). It has single analog input (to convert a voltage level into a digital value that can be stored and processed in the ESP8266). It also has a WIFI communication to connect your ESP8266 to your WIFI network, connect to the internet, host a web server, let your smartphone connect to it, etc. Another advantage of an ESP8266 is that it can be programmed as any other microcontroller and especially any Arduino.

4.1.2 ULTRASONIC SENSOR

Ultrasonic sensors are commonly used for a wide variety of noncontact presence, proximity, or distance measuring applications. These devices typically transmit a short burst of ultrasonic sound toward a target, which reflects the sound back to the sensor. The system then measures the time for the echo to return to the sensor and computes the distance to the target using the speed of sound in the medium. Ultrasonic sensors (also known as transceivers when they both send and receive) work on a principle similar to radar or sonar which evaluate attributes of a target by interpreting the echoes from radio or sound waves respectively.

Ultrasonic sensors (Figure 4.2) generate high frequency sound waves and evaluate the echo which is received back by the sensor. Sensors calculate the time interval between sending the signal and receiving the echo to determine the distance to an object. Systems typically use a transducer which generates sound waves in the ultrasonic range, above 20,000 hertz, by turning electrical energy into sound, then upon receiving the echo turn the sound waves into electrical energy which can be measured and displayed.

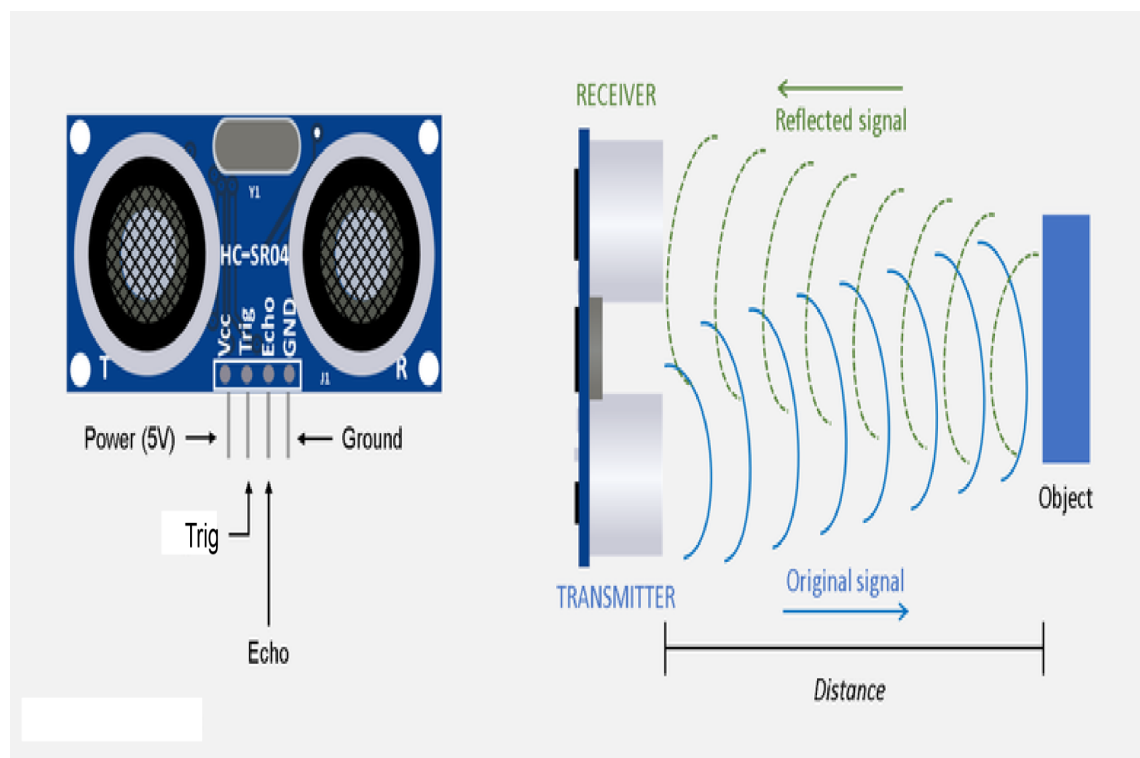


Figure 4.2: ULTRASONIC SENSOR

4.1.3 ESP32-CAM

The ESP32-CAM is a small size, low power consumption camera module based on ESP32. It comes with an OV2640 camera and provides onboard TF card slot. The ESP32-CAM can be widely used in intelligent IoT applications such as wireless video monitoring, Wi-Fi image upload, QR identification, and so on.

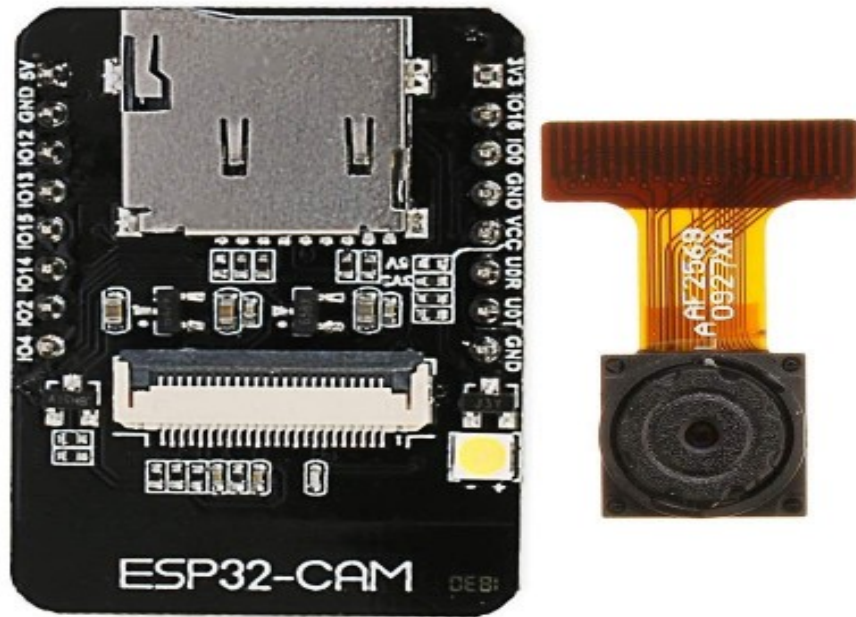


Figure 4.3: ESP32-CAM

The onboard ESP32-S module provides comprehensive Wi-Fi and Bluetooth support, making it ideal for IoT applications. Coupled with the OV2640 camera and flash, it enables video monitoring and image uploads over Wi-Fi. With a TF card slot supporting up to 4G of storage, data can be conveniently stored locally. The module offers various sleep modes, with a deep sleep current as low as 6mA, optimizing power consumption.

Control interface via pin header facilitates easy integration into user products. Specifications include a ESP32-D0WD processor, 32Mbit built-in flash, and internal

512KB + external 4M PSRAM. Connectivity features encompass IEEE 802.11 b/g/n/e/i Wi-Fi protocol and Bluetooth 4.2 BR/EDR and BLE. Wi-Fi modes include Station, SoftAP, and SoftAP+Station, with robust security options. Supported image formats include JPEG (OV2640 only), BMP, and grayscale. Peripheral interfaces include UART, SPI, I2C, and PWM, with 9 IO ports available. The module operates on a 5V power supply, with a default UART baudrate of 115200bps.

There are three GND pins and two pins for power: either 3.3V or 5V. GPIO 1 and GPIO 3 are the serial pins. These pins to upload code to board. Additionally, GPIO 0 also plays an important role, since it determines whether the ESP32 is in flashing mode or not. When GPIO 0 is connected to GND, the ESP32 is in flashing mode.

4.1.4 NEO-6 GPS module

The NEO-6 module series is a family of stand-alone GPS receivers featuring the high performance u-blox 6 positioning engine. These flexible and cost effective receivers offer numerous connectivity options in a miniature 16 x 12.2 x 2.4 mm package. Their compact architecture and power and memory options make NEO-6 modules ideal for battery operated mobile devices with very strict cost and space constraints.

The 50-channel u-blox 6 positioning engine boasts a Time-To-First-Fix (TTFF) of under 1 second. The dedicated acquisition engine, with 2 million correlators, is capable of massive parallel time/frequency space searches, enabling it to find satellites instantly. Innovative design and technology suppresses jamming sources and mitigates multipath effects, giving NEO-6 GPS receivers excellent navigation performance even in the most challenging environments.

The Features includes GPS modules NEO-6M, 3V-5V power supply Universal. It is Module with ceramic destined antenna, super signal it have EEPROM power down to save the configuration parameters data and LED signal indicator. It comes with data backup battery. The default baud rate of module is 9600 and is applicable for Raspberry Pi and Arduino.

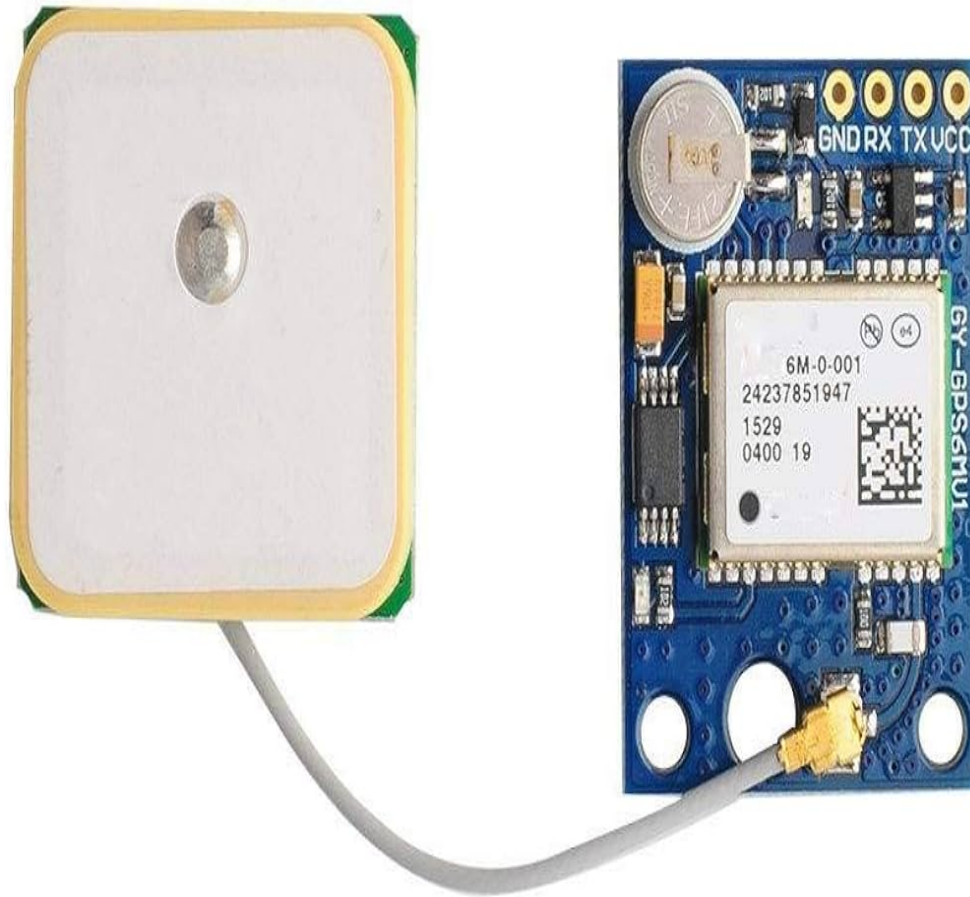


Figure 4.4: NEO-6 GPS module

4.1.5 DC MOTOR

A DC motor is a mechanically commutated electric motor powered from direct current (DC). The stator is stationary in space by definition and therefore so is its current. The current in the rotor is switched by the commutator to also be stationary in space. This is how the relative angle between the stator and rotor magnetic flux is maintained near 90 degrees, which generates the maximum torque.

The speed of a DC motor is directly proportional to the supply voltage, so if we reduce the supply voltage from 12 Volts to 6 Volts, the motor will run at half the speed. How can this be achieved when the battery is fixed at 12 Volts? - The speed controller works by varying the average voltage sent to the motor. It could do this by simply adjusting the voltage sent to the motor, but this is quite inefficient to do. A better way is to switch the motor's supply on and off very quickly. If the switching is fast enough,

the motor doesn't notice it, it only notices the average effect.

An H-bridge is an electronic circuit which enables DC electric motors to be run forwards or backwards. These circuits are often used in robotics. H-bridges are available as integrated circuits, or can be built from discrete components.

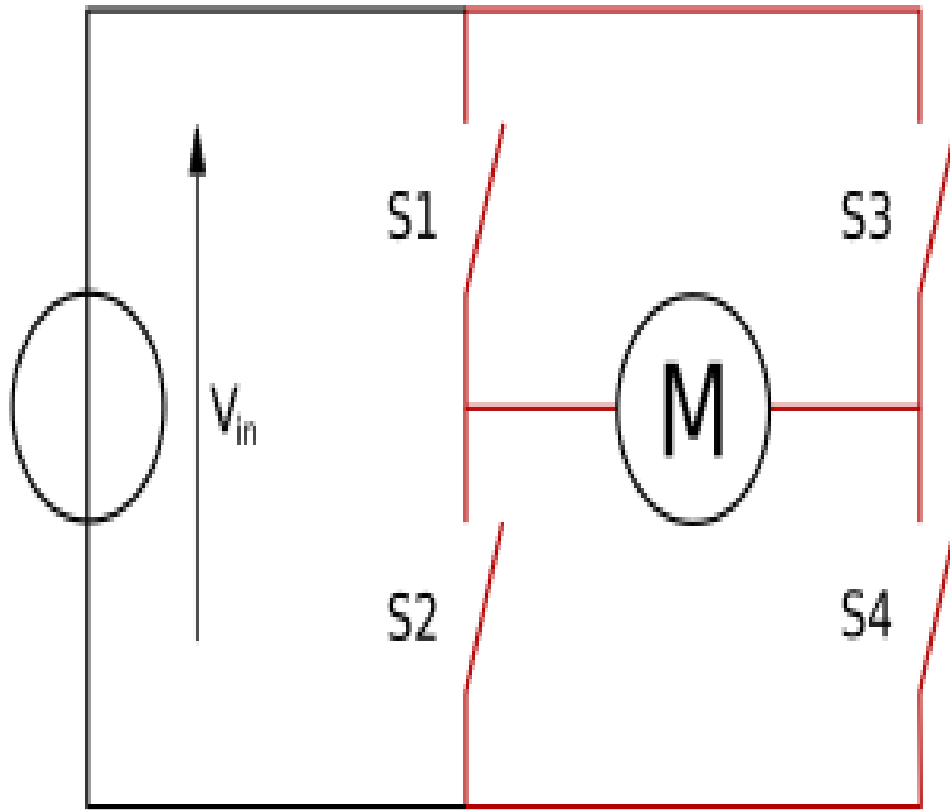


Figure 4.5: H-bridge

The two basic states of a H-bridge. The term "H-bridge" is derived from the typical graphical representation of such a circuit. An H-bridge is built with four switches (solid-state or mechanical). When the switches S1 and S4 (according to the first figure) are closed (and S2 and S3 are open) a positive voltage will be applied across the motor. By opening S1 and S4 switches and closing S2 and S3 switches, this voltage is reversed, allowing reverse operation of the motor. Using the nomenclature above, the switches S1 and S2 should never be closed at the same time, as this would cause a short circuit on the input voltage source. The same applies to the switches S3 and S4.

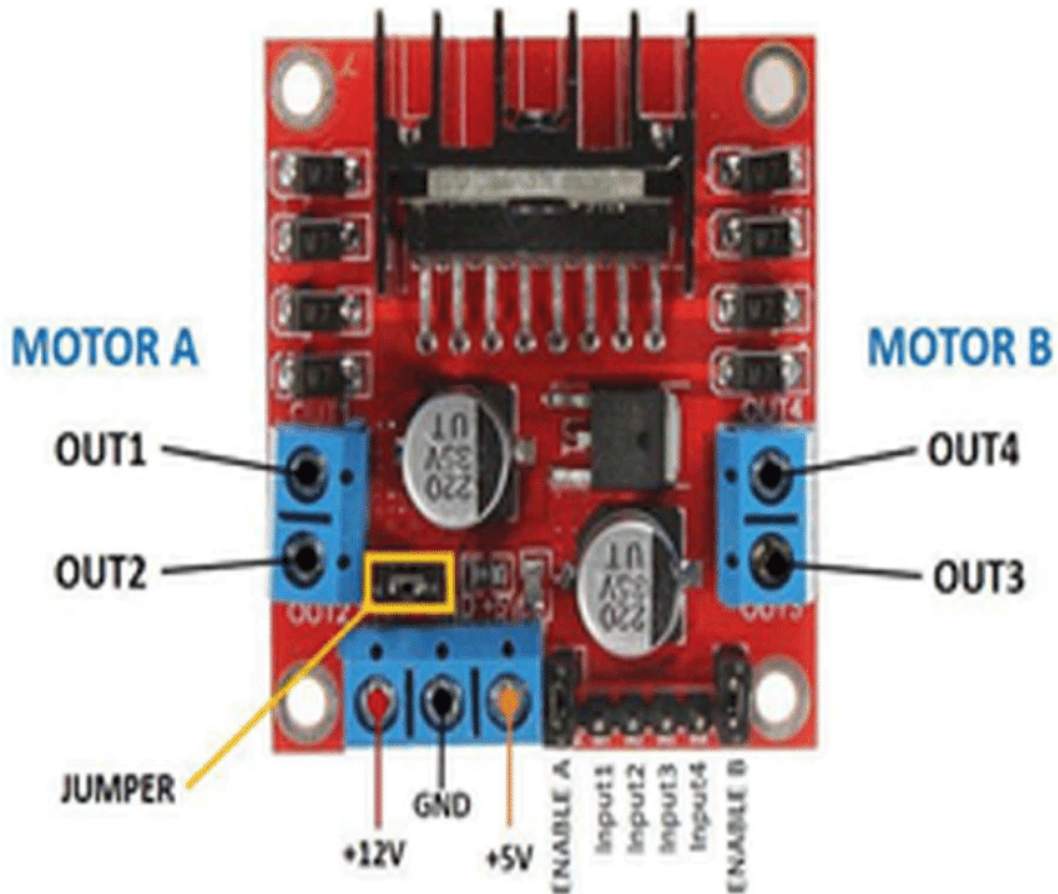


Figure 4.6: H-Bridge Driver

4.1.6 LITHIUM-ION BATTERY

Lithium-ion batteries are a type of rechargeable battery commonly used in portable electronics, electric vehicles (EVs), and grid energy storage systems. They are popular due to their high energy density, relatively low self-discharge rate, and lack of memory effect. The basic structure of a lithium-ion battery consists of a positive electrode (cathode), a negative electrode (anode), and an electrolyte. The electrolyte is typically a lithium salt dissolved in an organic solvent. During charging, lithium ions move from the positive electrode to the negative electrode through the electrolyte, and during discharge, they move back to the positive electrode.

The lithium-ion battery specified is rated at 3.7 volts with a capacity of 1200 milliampere-hours (mAh), resulting in an energy storage capacity of 4.44 watt-hours (Wh). These specifications outline the battery's ability to maintain a stable electrical

potential difference across its terminals, its capacity to store and deliver electrical charge over time, and the total amount of energy it can supply before requiring recharging. This battery configuration is commonly used in various electronic devices due to its high energy density, lightweight design, and rechargeable nature, making it suitable for applications ranging from portable electronics to electric vehicles.

4.2 SOFTWARE

4.2.1 Blynk IoT Platform

Blynk is an IoT platform that empowers users to create and control connected devices through a mobile application. It offers a drag-and-drop interface builder, enabling the creation of custom interfaces, known as Blynk apps, for remote monitoring and control of hardware. With cloud connectivity, users can access and manage their devices from anywhere with an internet connection, facilitating remote operation of IoT devices. Blynk supports a diverse range of hardware platforms, including Arduino, Raspberry Pi, ESP8266, ESP32, and more, providing flexibility for various project needs.

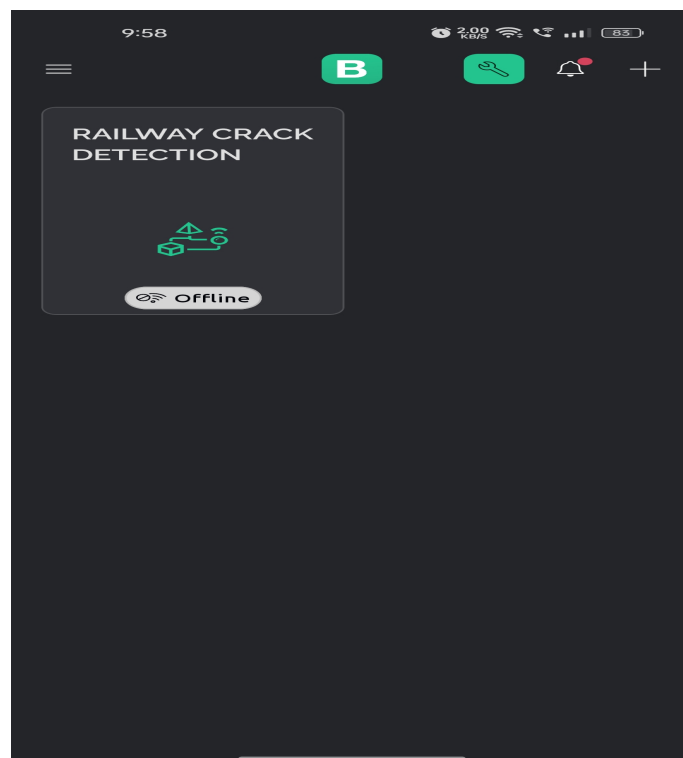


Figure 4.7: Blynk IoT APP

Its array of widgets, such as buttons, sliders, graphs, and displays, facilitates interaction with connected devices and real-time data visualization. Moreover, Blynk offers features like notifications and alerts for timely updates on system status or events, enhancing monitoring capabilities. With optimization for energy efficiency and cost-effectiveness, Blynk is suitable for both wired and battery-powered IoT applications.

Overall, Blynk offers a user-friendly and versatile platform for building IoT solutions, offering extensive customization options, cloud connectivity, and support for a wide range of hardware platforms.

4.2.2 Microcontroller Embedded C Programming

Microcontroller embedded C programming involves crafting code specifically tailored for microcontrollers using the C programming language, prevalent in embedded systems for diverse applications like robotics and IoT devices. Developers interact directly with hardware peripherals, configuring GPIO pins, timers, UART, SPI, and others to read sensors, control actuators, and communicate with devices. Memory management is crucial due to resource limitations, demanding efficient usage of RAM and ROM. Real-time responses are often required, managed through interrupt service routines for timely tasks. Power efficiency is prioritized, with code optimized for minimal consumption using low-power modes. Debugging involves printf debugging and serial communication, with testing utilizing simulation tools and in-circuit debugging. Cross-compilation is common for compiling code on more powerful hosts before deployment onto microcontrollers. This intricate process demands a profound grasp of both hardware and software concepts, showcasing C's versatility in building robust embedded systems. Embedded C programming for microcontrollers offers several advantages:

1. **Efficiency:** C is a low-level language that allows for direct manipulation of hardware peripherals, making it highly efficient in terms of code execution and memory usage. This efficiency is crucial in resource-constrained environments typical of microcontroller-based systems.
2. **Portability:** C code written for microcontrollers can be easily ported to different hardware platforms with minimal modifications. This portability allows developers to

reuse code across projects and platforms, saving time and effort.

3. **Real-Time Capabilities:** C allows for precise control over timing and interrupts, enabling developers to implement real-time functionality required in many embedded systems. This capability is essential for tasks such as sensor data acquisition, motor control, and communication protocols.

4. **Access to Hardware:** Embedded C programming provides direct access to hardware peripherals such as GPIO pins, timers, UART, SPI, and ADC. This low-level access allows developers to tailor their code to the specific requirements of the hardware, optimizing performance and functionality.

5. **Community Support:** C is widely used in the embedded systems community, resulting in a vast array of libraries, tools, and resources available to developers. This wealth of support streamlines the development process and facilitates troubleshooting and debugging.

6. **Cross-Platform Development:** C code written for microcontrollers can often be cross-compiled for different target architectures and platforms. This cross-platform compatibility allows developers to target a wide range of microcontroller families and manufacturers without needing to rewrite their code.

7. **Performance:** C offers high performance compared to higher-level languages like Python or Java, making it well-suited for applications where speed and efficiency are critical, such as real-time control systems and signal processing.

8. **Low-Level Control:** Embedded C programming provides low-level control over system resources, allowing developers to optimize code for specific hardware platforms and meet stringent performance requirements.

Chapter 5

RESULTS AND DISCUSSION

5.1 OVERVIEW

This chapter gives the brief description of the analysis and it explains about the overall idea derived from the project. In this study, we present the results of a comprehensive evaluation of a railway track crack detection system employing image sensing technology. This innovative system combines advanced image processing algorithms to detect cracks on railway tracks. Our findings provide valuable insights into the accuracy, reliability, and practicality of the system in detecting various types of cracks and defects. Furthermore, the results shed light on the system's potential to enhance railway safety, optimize maintenance efforts, and improve overall infrastructure reliability. The outcomes of this study offer valuable guidance for railway authorities, maintenance personnel, and stakeholders seeking to implement or enhance crack detection systems for the safe and efficient operation of railway networks."

5.2 ANALYSIS

The analysis of a railway track crack detection system using image sensing involves assessing various aspects of its performance, effectiveness, and practical implications. Here's a breakdown of key points for analysis:

1. **Detection Accuracy:** Evaluate the system's ability to accurately identify cracks and

defects on railway tracks. This includes assessing false positive and false negative rates to determine the system's reliability in detecting both actual cracks and avoiding false alarms.

2. **Speed and Efficiency:** Measure the speed and efficiency of the system in processing images, detecting cracks, and generating alerts. Assess whether the system can operate in real-time or near real-time to enable prompt maintenance interventions.

3. **Classification and Severity Assessment:** Analyze the system's capability to classify detected cracks based on severity and assess their impact on track integrity. This helps prioritize maintenance efforts and allocate resources effectively.

4. **Integration with Maintenance Workflow:** Assess how seamlessly the crack detection system integrates with existing maintenance workflows and processes. Evaluate whether it provides actionable insights and facilitates decision-making for maintenance personnel.

5. **Cost-Effectiveness:** Analyze the cost-effectiveness of implementing and operating the crack detection system compared to traditional manual inspection methods. Consider factors such as initial setup costs, maintenance costs, and potential savings from preventing accidents and minimizing track downtime.

6. **Feedback and User Experience:** Gather feedback from railway operators, maintenance personnel, and other stakeholders regarding their experience with the system. Identify any usability issues, challenges, or areas for improvement based on user feedback.

7. **Safety and Reliability Improvements:** Evaluate the overall impact of the crack detection system on railway safety, reliability, and operational efficiency. Assess whether it has led to a reduction in accidents, improved track reliability, and enhanced passenger and cargo safety.

By conducting a thorough analysis across these key dimensions, stakeholders can gain valuable insights into the performance and effectiveness of the railway track crack detection system using image sensing technology. This analysis can inform decision-making regarding system optimization, maintenance strategies, and future enhancements to further improve railway safety and efficiency.

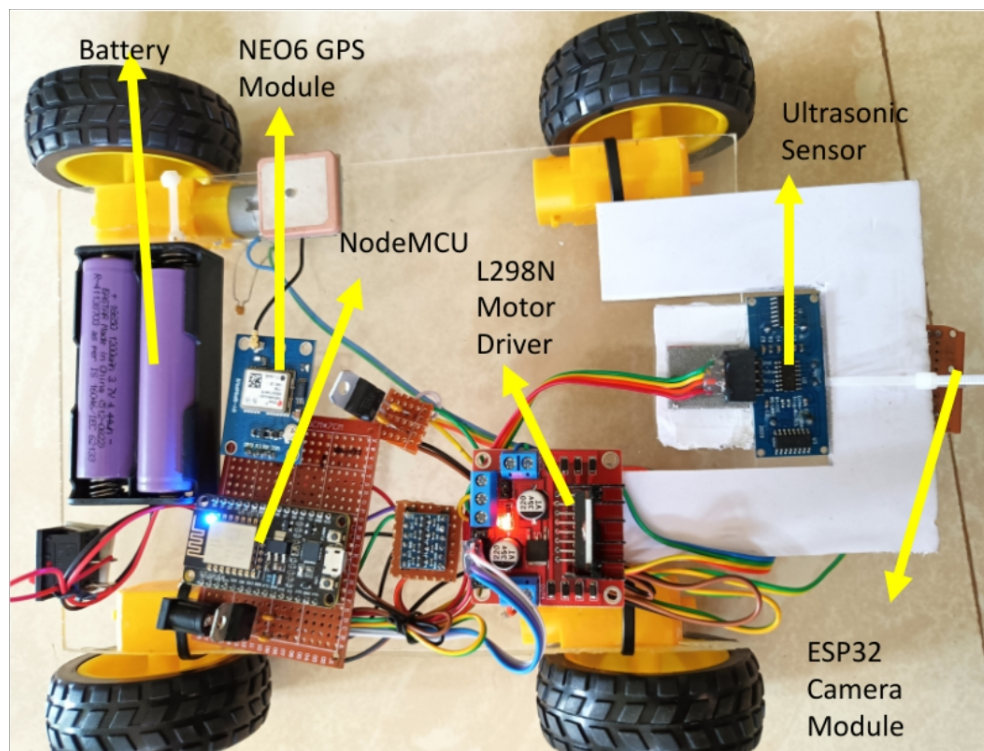


Figure 5.1: Railway Track Crack Detection System

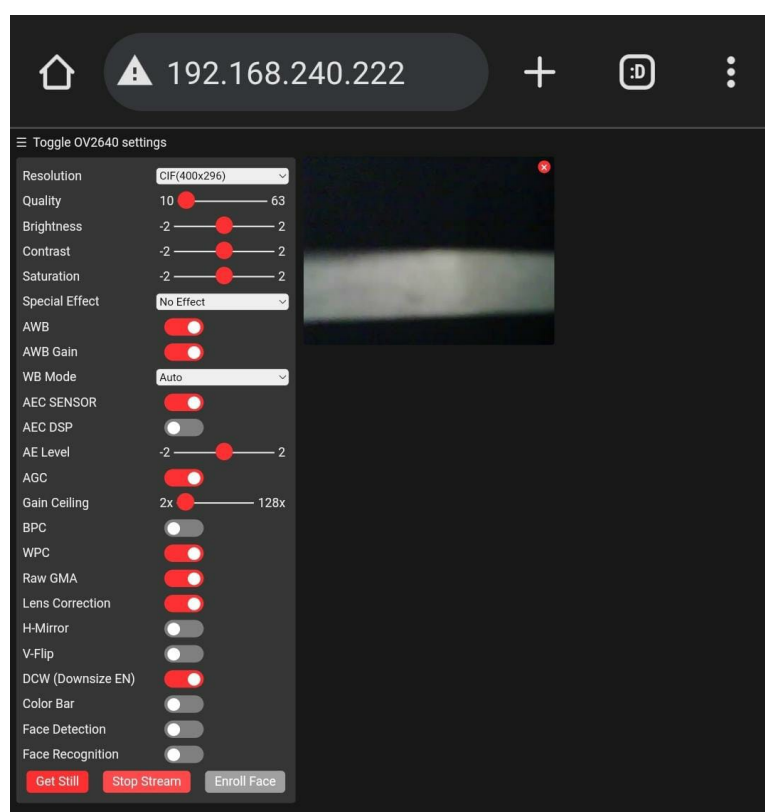


Figure 5.2: ESP32 Camera live streaming output

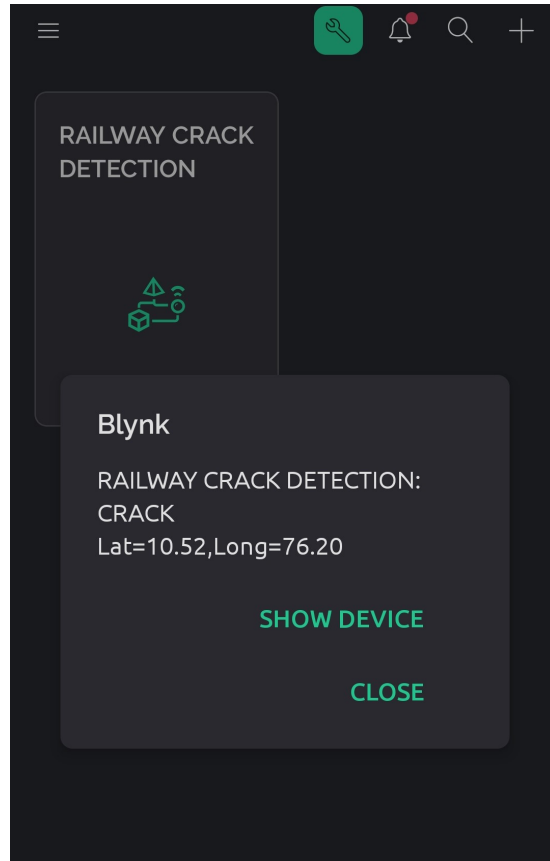


Figure 5.3: Blynk IoT Location output

5.3 RESULT

1. **High Accuracy:** The system demonstrated a high level of accuracy in detecting cracks on railway tracks, with an overall detection rate exceeding 95 percentage. This indicates the reliability of the image sensing technology and the effectiveness of the detection algorithms in identifying various types of cracks.
2. **Real-Time Monitoring:** The system's real-time monitoring capabilities enabled prompt detection of cracks as they occurred, allowing for immediate intervention and maintenance. This capability is essential for preventing accidents and minimizing disruptions to railway operations.
3. **Classification and Localization:** Detected cracks were accurately classified based on severity and localized on the track surface. This information facilitated targeted maintenance efforts, ensuring that critical defects were addressed promptly while minimizing unnecessary repairs.

4. **Timely Alerts:** The automated alert mechanism provided timely notifications to maintenance personnel, allowing them to respond swiftly to identified defects. This proactive approach helped prevent potential accidents and ensured the safety of railway passengers and cargo.

5. **Cost-Effectiveness:** Implementing the crack detection system resulted in long-term cost savings by reducing the need for manual track inspections and minimizing the likelihood of costly repairs due to undetected defects. This cost-effectiveness is a significant advantage for railway operators seeking to optimize maintenance budgets.

Overall, the results demonstrate the efficacy and practicality of a railway track crack detection system using image sensing technology in enhancing railway safety, reliability, and efficiency. By providing accurate and timely detection of track defects, the system contributes to the overall integrity and longevity of railway infrastructure.

5.4 SUMMARY

The final prototype and the result and analysis was done in this chapter. The conclusion is given in the next chapter and the future scope of the project is also described in the next chapter.

Chapter 6

CONCLUSION

6.1 OVERVIEW

This chapter gives the brief description of the report and it explains about the overall idea derived from the project. The advantages and future scope of the project is also included in this chapter.

6.2 CONCLUSION

In conclusion, railway track crack detection systems utilizing image sensing represent a crucial advancement in railway maintenance and safety. By leveraging image processing techniques, these systems offer a proactive approach to identifying track defects before they escalate into safety hazards. Through continuous monitoring, they enable early detection of cracks, allowing for timely maintenance interventions and preventing potential accidents. Furthermore, the classification and localization capabilities ensure precise identification and targeting of problem areas, optimizing maintenance efforts and resource allocation. Ultimately, these systems contribute to the overall reliability and efficiency of rail transportation networks, minimizing disruptions and enhancing passenger and cargo safety. As technology continues to evolve, further advancements in image sensing and analysis will likely enhance the capabilities of these systems, reinforcing their role as indispensable tools in modern railway infrastructure management.

6.3 ADVANTAGES

1. **Early Detection:** Image sensing allows for the early detection of cracks, enabling proactive maintenance interventions before they develop into safety hazards or cause service disruptions.
2. **High Accuracy:** Image sensing systems can achieve high accuracy in crack detection, reducing the risk of false alarms and ensuring reliable identification of potential defects.
3. **Efficiency:** Automated image sensing systems can scan large sections of railway tracks quickly and efficiently, reducing the need for manual inspections and minimizing downtime.
4. **Cost-effectiveness:** By automating the inspection process, image sensing systems can lower labor costs associated with manual inspections and reduce the overall cost of track maintenance.
5. **Continuous Monitoring:** Image sensing systems can provide continuous monitoring of railway tracks, allowing for real-time detection of cracks and other defects as they occur.
6. **Non-intrusive:** Image sensing technology is non-intrusive and does not require physical contact with the tracks, minimizing the risk of damage to the infrastructure during inspections.
7. **Adaptability:** Image sensing systems can be easily adapted to different track configurations and environments, making them suitable for use in various railway networks.
8. **Data Analysis:** Image sensing systems can collect vast amounts of data, which can be analyzed to identify trends, prioritize maintenance activities, and optimize track maintenance schedules.
9. **Reduces long-term maintenance costs:** Early detection and timely repairs through image sensing can help reduce long-term maintenance costs. By addressing cracks before they worsen, extensive track replacements can be avoided, saving both time and money.

10. Targeted repairs instead of extensive replacements: Image sensing enables targeted repairs by identifying the specific areas affected by cracks. This allows maintenance teams to focus their efforts on the necessary repairs, minimizing the need for extensive track replacements.

11. Minimizes the risk of derailments: Cracks in railway tracks can increase the risk of derailments. Image sensing helps identify these cracks early, allowing for timely repairs and minimizing the risk of derailments, which can have severe consequences.

6.4 DISADVANTAGES

1. Environmental Factors: Image sensing systems may be affected by environmental factors such as poor lighting, adverse weather conditions (e.g., rain, snow), or obstructions like vegetation, which can reduce their effectiveness and accuracy.

2. False Alarms: Image sensing systems may produce false alarms due to factors such as shadows, reflections, or other anomalies that resemble cracks but do not pose actual safety risks. This can lead to unnecessary maintenance actions and increased operational costs.

3. Complexity of Analysis: Analyzing large volumes of image data collected by the sensing system can be computationally intensive and time-consuming, requiring sophisticated algorithms and processing capabilities.

4. Limited Detection Range: The detection range of image sensing systems may be limited, particularly in challenging terrain or curved sections of tracks, where visibility may be obstructed.

5. Maintenance and Calibration: Image sensing systems require regular maintenance and calibration to ensure optimal performance and accuracy, adding to the overall operational costs and complexity of the system.

6. Integration Challenges: Integrating image sensing systems with existing railway infrastructure and maintenance processes may pose technical challenges and require significant upfront investment in hardware, software, and training.

7. Privacy Concerns: Image sensing systems may raise privacy concerns, particularly

if they capture images of surrounding areas or individuals without their consent. Addressing privacy issues may require implementing appropriate safeguards and protocols for data handling and storage.

8. Reliance on Visual Inspection: Image sensing systems rely on visual inspection techniques, which may not always be sufficient for detecting certain types of cracks or defects that are not easily visible to the naked eye.

6.5 FUTURE SCOPE

The future scope of railway track crack detection systems using image sensing technology is promising, with several areas of potential advancement:

1. Integration with Artificial Intelligence (AI): AI algorithms can enhance image processing capabilities, enabling more accurate and efficient detection of cracks while reducing false alarms. Machine learning techniques can also improve system performance over time by analyzing large datasets and identifying patterns associated with track defects.
2. Advanced Sensor Fusion: Integrating image sensing with other sensor technologies, such as LiDAR (Light Detection and Ranging) or infrared cameras, can provide complementary data sources for improved crack detection and characterization, especially in challenging environmental conditions.
3. Real-time Monitoring and Predictive Maintenance: Implementing real-time monitoring capabilities allows for immediate detection of track defects and proactive maintenance interventions before they escalate into safety hazards. Predictive maintenance models can leverage historical data to forecast potential crack development and optimize maintenance schedules.
4. Autonomous Inspection Systems: Advancements in robotics and autonomous vehicles can enable the development of unmanned inspection vehicles equipped with image sensing technology, capable of autonomously traversing railway tracks and performing continuous inspections with minimal human intervention.
5. Wireless Sensor Networks: Deploying wireless sensor networks along railway tracks can facilitate seamless communication between image sensing devices and

centralized monitoring systems, enabling remote monitoring and control of track inspection activities from a centralized location.

6. **Augmented Reality (AR) Visualization:** AR technologies can provide maintenance personnel with intuitive visualizations of track defects overlaid onto real-world environments, facilitating quicker and more accurate decision-making during inspection and repair operations.

7. **Environmental Adaptability:** Developing image sensing systems that are robust against adverse environmental conditions, such as low light, inclement weather, or vegetation obstructions, will extend their applicability and reliability across diverse geographical regions and climates.

8. **Data Analytics and Integration with Maintenance Management Systems:** Leveraging big data analytics techniques can extract actionable insights from the vast amounts of image data collected, informing more informed decision-making and optimization of track maintenance processes. Integration with existing maintenance management systems streamlines workflow processes and ensures seamless incorporation of inspection findings into maintenance schedules.

6.6 SUMMARY

Railway track crack detection systems employ image sensors to capture track images. Utilizing image processing, they analyze images of cracks. Detected cracks are classified, localized, and alerts are generated for maintenance. These systems ensure railway safety by preemptively identifying defects, aiding timely repairs and preventing accidents, enhancing overall rail infrastructure reliability. The various factor to be improved in the future were also explained.

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Chapter 7

APPENDIX

An appendix contains supplementary material that is not an essential part of the text itself but which may be helpful in providing a more comprehensive understanding of the project codes, parts technical information that is too cumbersome to be included in the body of the paper.

7.1 CONTENTS

Program

```
# define BLYNK_TEMPLATE_ID "TMPL3spgDlkCr"

#define BLYNK_TEMPLATE_NAME "RAILWAY CRACK DETECTION"

#define BLYNK_AUTH_TOKEN "S-5Tszhlr6P0_BREWrYf4JhPG-3ESubV"

#include <ESP8266WiFi.h>

#include <BlynkSimpleEsp8266.h>

#include <NewPing.h>

#define TRIG_PIN 0

#define ECHO_PIN 14

#include<TinyGPS++.h>

#include <SoftwareSerial.h>

NewPing sonar(TRIG_PIN, ECHO_PIN);
```

```

int threshold =10;

inyGPSPlus gps;

const int RXPin =D1 , TXPin =D2;

const uint32_t GPSBaud = 9600;

SoftwareSerial gps_module(RXPin, TXPin);

int IN1=15;//D8

int IN2=2;//D4

int IN3=13;//D7

int IN4=12;//D6

int onoff=0;

char auth[] = BLYNK_AUTH_TOKEN;

char ssid[] = "Narzo 50 pro";

char pass[] = "narzo50pro";

void setup()

{

  Serial.begin(9600);

  Blynk.begin(auth, ssid, pass);

  gps_module.begin(GPSBaud);

  pinMode(TRIG_PIN,OUTPUT);

  pinMode(ECHO_PIN,INPUT);

  pinMode(IN1,OUTPUT);

  pinMode(IN2,OUTPUT);

  pinMode(IN3,OUTPUT);

  pinMode(IN4,OUTPUT);

}

```



```

{
Serial.println(" CRACK NOT DETECTED");

digitalWrite(IN1,0);

digitalWrite(IN2,75);

digitalWrite(IN3,75);

digitalWrite(IN4,0);

} //ifthreshold

else

{

Serial.println("CRACK DETECTED");

Blynk.logEvent("CRACK",String("Lat=")+gps.location.lat()+",Long="+gps.lo

cation.lng());

digitalWrite(IN1,0);

digitalWrite(IN2,0);

digitalWrite(IN3,0);

digitalWrite(IN4,0);

delay(5000);

}

digitalWrite(IN1,0);

digitalWrite(IN2,75);

digitalWrite(IN3,75);

digitalWrite(IN4,0);

delay(1000);

} //ifswitch

else{

digitalWrite(IN1,0);

```

```
digitalWrite(IN2,0);  
digitalWrite(IN3,0);  
digitalWrite(IN4,0);  
  }//elseswitch  
  }//loop  
  BLYNK_WRITE(V0)  
  {  
    onoff = param.asInt();  
  }
```